

Question 41 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of Training Needs Assessment (TNA) and state its importance in HRD.

Answer

Training Needs Assessment (TNA) is the systematic process of identifying gaps between required and actual competencies at organisation, task and person levels, and deciding whether training is the right solution. $\text{Need} \approx \text{Standard performance} - \text{Actual performance}$, but only when the cause is a lack of KSA.

- 1. Organisation analysis:** Links firm strategy/goals to where training is needed and whether climate will support it.
- 2. Task analysis:** Identifies important tasks and the knowledge, skills and attitudes required.
- 3. Person analysis:** Identifies who needs training by comparing employee KSAs with job requirements.
- 4. Importance – relevance:** Prevents ‘off-the-shelf’ programmes that do not fit.
- 5. Importance – diagnosis:** Distinguishes training needs from problems of motivation, tools, or process design.
- 6. Importance – priority and budget:** Directs scarce HRD resources to critical gaps.
- 7. Importance – design quality:** Supplies objectives, content and method choices for the training plan.
- 8. Importance – evaluation baseline:** Defines what success will look like, enabling later Kirkpatrick evaluation.

Conclusion. *TNA is therefore the foundation of HRD training: without it, design, delivery and evaluation rest on guesswork.*